

The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People — Mastery Quiz

Author: Stephen R. Covey • 12 multiple-choice questions • Answer + explanation

Instructions: Choose the best answer before checking the answer and explanation.

1. What does *being proactive* mean?

- A. Blaming circumstances
- B. Choosing your response and taking responsibility
- C. Waiting for others
- D. Avoiding decisions

Correct answer: B

Why: Proactivity focuses on response, responsibility and choice.

2. What does *'begin with the end in mind'* mean?

- A. Start without goals
- B. Define the desired destination and values first
- C. Avoid planning
- D. Focus only on urgent tasks

Correct answer: B

Why: The habit aligns current choices with the life and values you want.

3. What does *'put first things first'* emphasize?

- A. Urgency only
- B. Prioritizing important work
- C. Doing everything
- D. Avoiding schedules

Correct answer: B

Why: Effective people protect important priorities rather than allowing urgency to dominate.

4. What is the *Circle of Influence*?

- A. Everything you worry about
- B. Things you can actually affect
- C. Things other people control
- D. The entire world

Correct answer: B

Why: Focusing on influence directs energy toward actionable areas.

5. What does win-win mean?

- A. One side must lose
- B. Seek mutually beneficial outcomes
- C. Avoid negotiation
- D. Always compromise

Correct answer: B

Why: Win-win seeks solutions that respect both parties' interests.

6. What is the principle behind 'seek first to understand'?

- A. Listen before trying to persuade
- B. Speak first
- C. Avoid empathy
- D. Win arguments

Correct answer: A

Why: Understanding another person's perspective improves communication and problem solving.

7. What is synergy?

- A. Eliminating differences
- B. Creating better outcomes by combining different strengths and perspectives
- C. Working alone
- D. Avoiding collaboration

Correct answer: B

Why: Synergy treats differences as potential sources of better solutions.

8. What is Habit 7?

- A. Sharpen the Saw
- B. Begin with the End
- C. Think Win-Win
- D. Be Proactive

Correct answer: A

Why: Sharpen the Saw means regularly renewing yourself across important dimensions.

9. Which is part of renewal?

- A. Physical, mental, social/emotional and purpose
- B. Only financial
- C. Only professional
- D. Only physical

Correct answer: A

Why: The habit includes multiple dimensions of renewal.

10. What is the overall progression of the first six habits?

- A. Dependence → Independence → Interdependence
- B. Independence → Dependence → Isolation
- C. Urgency → Stress → Burnout
- D. Work → Sleep → Work

Correct answer: A

Why: The sequence moves from personal effectiveness to effective interdependence.

11. What is a 'big rock'?

- A. An important priority that should be scheduled first
- B. A physical object
- C. A low-value task
- D. An emergency only

Correct answer: A

Why: Important priorities should be placed into the calendar before smaller tasks fill the available time.

12. What is the central message of the seven habits?

- A. Effectiveness is doing more things
- B. Effectiveness comes from principles, priorities, relationships and renewal
- C. Speed is everything
- D. Avoid collaboration

Correct answer: B

Why: The framework is about living and working according to principles while managing priorities and relationships.

Scoring guide: 10–12 = strong mastery • 7–9 = good understanding • 4–6 = review the summary • 0–3 = reread the core concepts.